

**Metadata**

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- \* **Author:** Janet Cohen
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## 1. Document Scope and Executive Summary

This Architecture Reference Document (ARD) provides a comprehensive overview of the department's policies, procedures, and standards.

The scope of this ARD includes:

- \* Defining architecture principles and standards
- \* Outlining the architecture development process
- \* Describing architecture governance and compliance
- \* Providing guidelines for architecture documentation and communication

## 2. Core Policies and Standard Operating Procedures

### 2.1 Architecture Development Process

The architecture development process involves the following stages:

1. **Initiation**: Identify business needs, define project scope, and establish goals.
2. **Analysis**: Conduct stakeholder interviews, gather requirements, and analyze existing systems.
3. **Design**: Create architecture designs, develop prototypes, and validate solutions.
4. **Implementation**: Develop and deploy architectures, integrate with existing systems, and conduct testing.
5. **Maintenance**: Monitor and maintain architectures, perform upgrades, and ensure ongoing compliance.

### 2.2 Architecture Governance

The department will adhere to the following governance principles:

1. **Architecture Committee**: Establish a committee to review, approve, and oversee architecture decisions.
2. **Change Management**: Implement change management processes to ensure controlled changes to architectures.
3. **Risk Assessment**: Conduct risk assessments to identify potential threats and opportunities.

### 2.3 Architecture Documentation

The department will maintain the following documentation:

1. **Architecture Description**: Provide a high-level overview of each architecture, including goals, principles, and components.
2. **Architecture diagrams**: Create visual representations of architectures using standard notations (e.g., UML, BPMN).
3. **Change Requests**: Document all changes to architectures, including rationale and impact assessments.

## 3. Compliance Monitoring, Penalties, and Operational Governance

### 3.1 Compliance Monitoring

The department will conduct regular compliance monitoring to ensure adherence to architecture principles, standards, and policies.

1. **Audits**: Conduct internal audits to assess architecture compliance.
2. **Reporting**: Provide regular reports on architecture compliance status.

### 3.2 Penalties

Non-compliance with architecture principles, standards, and policies may result in penalties, including:

1. **Warning**: Issue a written warning for minor non-compliances.
2. **Corrective Action**: Require corrective action to address major non-compliances.
3. **Punitive Measures**: Implement punitive measures (e.g., suspension, termination) for severe or repeated non-compliance.

### 3.3 Operational Governance

The department will establish the following operational governance procedures:

1. **Issue Tracking**: Maintain an issue tracking system to manage architecture-related issues and requests.
2. **Communication**: Establish clear communication channels among stakeholders, including regular meetings and status updates.

By adhering to this Architecture Reference Document, the department aims to ensure consistent, high-quality architectural decisions.